

■ There is also an interactive HTML version of this guide.

The HTML version lets you type your answers directly into the page, saves your progress automatically in your browser, and is designed for working through digitally. Download it from your thank-you email, or find it at:

mindfulearth.eco/pages/grounded-growth/



MINDFUL EARTH · RETREAT PLANNING GUIDE

Grounded *Growth.*

The complete retreat and event planning guide — from first concept through venue, budget, legal, day-of execution, and post-event growth.

A NOTE FROM MONTANA

I made Grounded Growth because I have been the practitioner sitting in front of a blank spreadsheet at 11pm, trying to plan an event that should have felt exciting but just felt overwhelming. Six years of international retreat hosting taught me what I wish someone had told me before the first one. This guide is that resource.

ABOUT MINDFUL EARTH

A wellness ecosystem for practitioners, seekers, and the people building something real. Community, education, experiences, and the support to grow sustainably — without burning out first. Based in London. Working globally.

mindfulearth.eco · connect@mindfulearth.eco · CA\$22

[@mindfulearth.eco](https://www.instagram.com/mindfulearth.eco)

Return to *Yourself First*.

Before you open a budget spreadsheet, before you check venue availability, before you write a single word of marketing copy — come back to yourself. Your event will only be as grounded as you are.

The most meaningful events are not born from hustle. They are born from stillness — from a practitioner who knows why they are doing this, who they are doing it for, and what they genuinely have to offer. That clarity only comes from within.

YOUR PRACTICE BEFORE YOUR BUSINESS

What is your current practice? How are you showing up for yourself right now? Before you plan an event for others, take stock of where you are.

HOW AM I SHOWING UP FOR MYSELF RIGHT NOW?

WHAT IS MY DEEPEST INTENTION FOR THIS EVENT?

WHAT DO I WANT PARTICIPANTS TO FEEL WHEN THEY LEAVE?

Nourish yourself before nourishing others

Your capacity to hold space for others is directly tied to how well you are holding space for yourself. Before this event launches, check in honestly: are you resourced enough to give what this asks of you?

MY CURRENT ENERGY / CAPACITY (1–10)

WHAT DO I NEED BEFORE LAUNCH?

MY NON-NEGOTIABLE SELF-CARE PRACTICES DURING THE PLANNING PERIOD

10 Steps to *Your Event*.

A high-level roadmap. Every step is expanded in detail in the sections that follow. Work through them in order — each builds on the last.

- ☐ Ground yourself and clarify your vision — the foundation everything grows from
 - ☐ Choose your format — workshop, day event, weekend retreat, full week, or international
 - ☐ Build your budget before you book anything — know your numbers first
 - ☐ Find and secure your venue — the biggest lever on the experience you create
 - ☐ Build your team and confirm partnerships — the people who hold the event with you
 - ☐ Sort your forms and insurance — the layer that protects everyone
 - ☐ Open bookings and begin marketing — with a clear message and a simple system
 - ☐ Work through the pre-event checklists — 8 weeks out through the morning of
 - ☐ Run the event with presence — hold the space, not the agenda
 - ☐ Follow up, rest, and reflect — what happens after shapes the next one
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Vision & *Business Case.*

Before anything practical, you need a clear concept. Not a vague intention — a specific, articulated vision of what this event is, who it is for, and what they will leave with.

Every decision you make in the planning process — venue, price, format, marketing — flows from your vision. Without a clear vision, you find yourself making decisions by default rather than by design.

The Event Concept

WHAT IS THE CORE CONCEPT OF THIS EVENT? (ONE SENTENCE)

THE TRANSFORMATION — WHAT CHANGES FOR SOMEONE WHO ATTENDS?

YOUR UNIQUE LENS — WHAT MAKES THIS YOURS?

Events as a Business Development Tool

COMMUNITY A well-run event creates a room of people who share your values. That community becomes your most powerful marketing.	CREDIBILITY Hosting builds visible authority in a way that posting never quite does. You become someone who creates experiences, not just shares them.
INCOME Events generate concentrated income. A single well-run retreat can equal months of 1:1 session revenue.	CONTENT Photos, testimonials, and stories from your event become the marketing for the next one. Each event compounds the last.

Format Overview

FORMAT	DURATION	COMPLEXITY	PRICE RANGE
Workshop	2-4 hours	Low	CA\$40-150
Full-Day Event	6-8 hours	Medium	CA\$100-350
Weekend Retreat	2-3 days	Medium-High	CA\$500-2,500
Full-Week Retreat	5-7 days	High	CA\$1,500-6,000
International Retreat	5-10 days	Very High	CA\$3,500-10,000+

MY CHOSEN FORMAT AND WHY

TARGET NUMBER OF PARTICIPANTS (MIN / IDEAL / MAX)

The Scaling *Framework.*

Every format has a different risk profile, resource requirement, and revenue potential. Know which one you are building before you start planning. Start smaller than you think you need to. A workshop with 10 people done exceptionally well will do more for your business than a retreat with 20 done adequately.

Master the smaller format first. Scale when you have the systems, the team, and the testimonials to support it.

Format Comparison

FORMAT	DURATION	PARTICIPANTS	LEAD TIME	REVENUE POTENTIAL
Workshop	2-4 hrs	8-25	4-6 wks	CA\$500-3,000
Half-Day Event	4-6 hrs	10-30	5-8 wks	CA\$800-5,000
Full-Day Event	6-10 hrs	10-40	6-10 wks	CA\$1,500-8,000
Weekend Retreat	2-3 days	6-20	10-16 wks	CA\$5,000-25,000
Full-Week Retreat	5-7 days	6-16	16-24 wks	CA\$15,000-60,000
International Retreat	5-10 days	6-14	20-32 wks	CA\$20,000-80,000+
Day Festival	8-12 hrs	30-150+	16-24 wks	CA\$5,000-40,000

Format Deep-Dive

WORKSHOP / HALF-DAY Lowest risk. Highest repeatability. Best starting point. One focused theme, one or two facilitators, 2-6 hours. Low overhead, fast to fill, and the feedback loop is immediate. Run 3-4 before scaling up.	FULL-DAY EVENT A meaningful step up in complexity. Requires catering, full-day venue hire, and more detailed programme design. Can generate CA\$1,500-8,000 with the right positioning. Arc and rhythm matter here.
WEEKEND RETREAT Where the real transformation happens. 2-3 days, usually residential. Higher investment from participants, higher intimacy, higher logistics	FULL-WEEK / INTERNATIONAL Your flagship offering. Premium pricing, premium experience, premium logistics. Do not attempt until you have hosted at least one successful

complexity. Build your team before attempting this format.

overnight retreat. The rewards are significant; so is the complexity.

MY CHOSEN FORMAT FOR THIS EVENT AND WHY

WHAT WOULD THE NEXT FORMAT UP LOOK LIKE FOR ME?

Budget & *Financials.*

Know your numbers before you commit to anything. A budget built on your minimum viable participants protects you. A financially sustainable event is what makes the next one possible.

The golden rule: build your budget around minimum viable numbers, not best-case. If the event covers costs with 60% of your target capacity, you can host it with confidence.

Full Budget Template

CATEGORY	ESTIMATED COST	ACTUAL COST	NOTES
Venue hire			
Accommodation (if applicable)			
Food & catering			
Guest facilitators / team			
Equipment / props / supplies			
Photography / videography			
Marketing & design			
Platform & booking fees			
Insurance			
Travel & transport			
Welcome gifts / materials			
Contingency (10%)			
TOTAL COSTS			

Pricing Framework

COST-PLUS PRICING Total costs ÷ minimum participants + your fee = minimum ticket price. Your floor. Never go below this.	VALUE-BASED PRICING Price the outcome, not the hours. If this genuinely shifts someone's life, the value far exceeds the cost.
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MINIMUM TICKET PRICE (COST-PLUS CALCULATION)

MY ACTUAL TICKET PRICE AND WHY

REVENUE AT MINIMUM / IDEAL / FULL CAPACITY

Revenue Projection

SCENARIO	PARTICIPANTS	TICKET PRICE	GROSS REVENUE	TOTAL COSTS	NET PROFIT
Minimum viable					
Conservative					
Target					
Sold out					

Your minimum viable scenario is your floor. If the numbers don't work at minimum viable, adjust your costs or your price before you open bookings.

Venue, Team & Partnerships.

Choosing your venue well is the single biggest lever you have on the quality of the experience you create. The space sets the tone before you say a single word.

Venue Selection Checklist

- ☐ Energetic alignment – does this space feel right for the work?
- ☐ Practical accessibility – transport links, parking, accessibility needs
- ☐ Facilities – kitchen, bathrooms, breakout spaces, outdoor access
- ☐ Flexibility – can you arrange the space the way you need it?
- ☐ Contract clarity – what is included, what is not, cancellation terms
- ☐ Accommodation – on-site or nearby options for overnight events

VENUE SHORTLIST (NAME, LOCATION, PRICE, PROS/CONS)

Your Team

ROLE	NAME / CONFIRMED	FEE	NOTES
Co-facilitator			
Photographer			
Logistics support			
Caterer / food			
Other			

Get everything in writing. Every team member, every supplier, every venue. A simple written agreement protects everyone and prevents misunderstandings.

Brand Partnerships & Welcome Gifts

Well-chosen brand partnerships add value for participants, reduce your costs, and create marketing relationships that benefit everyone. The rule: only partner with brands your participants already use and love.

ALIGNED PARTNERSHIP CRITERIA

Does this brand share your values? Would you use this product yourself? Does it add genuine value to the retreat experience — or is it just free stuff?

WHAT TO OFFER IN RETURN

Product placement, social mention, newsletter feature, event photography, testimonial. Keep terms simple and get them in writing.

Welcome Pack Checklist

- ☐ Welcome letter from you — personal, warm, sets the tone
- ☐ Schedule and what to expect
- ☐ What to bring / what is provided
- ☐ Venue and logistics info
- ☐ One or two small gifts aligned with the retreat theme
- ☐ Any partner product samples
- ☐ Emergency contact and health intake reference

MY WELCOME PACK ITEMS

POTENTIAL BRAND PARTNERS TO APPROACH

Forms, Legal & Insurance.

The layer that protects you, protects your participants, and ensures you can run events with confidence. Build these templates once – use them for every event.

The Six Forms You Need

- ☐ Registration / Sign-Up Form – name, contact, any special requirements
- ☐ Liability Waiver – physical activities, emotional content, voluntary participation
- ☐ Media Release – photos and video consent for marketing use
- ☐ Health Intake Form – relevant conditions, medications, contraindications
- ☐ Pre-Retreat Information Pack – what to bring, what to expect, logistics
- ☐ Feedback Form – post-event, 5–8 questions, includes testimonial prompt

Insurance Checklist

- ☐ Public liability insurance confirmed
- ☐ Professional indemnity insurance confirmed
- ☐ Venue's insurance requirements reviewed and met
- ☐ International travel insurance for overseas events
- ☐ Cancellation cover reviewed (optional but recommended)

Form Status Tracker

FORM	BUILT	TESTED	LIVE
Registration			
Liability Waiver			
Media Release			
Health Intake			
Info Pack			
Feedback Form			

Pre-Event *Execution.*

Quality preparation is what allows you to be fully present when the event begins. Work through these checklists as you approach your date.

8–12 Weeks Before

- ☐ Venue confirmed and deposit paid
 - ☐ Ticket price set and booking page live
 - ☐ Marketing begun — email and social
 - ☐ Team confirmed with written agreements
 - ☐ Forms built and tested
 - ☐ Insurance confirmed
-

4–6 Weeks Before

- ☐ Participants communicated with — what to expect, what to bring
 - ☐ Catering confirmed and dietary requirements collected
 - ☐ Run of show drafted
 - ☐ Welcome pack / materials prepared
 - ☐ Final participant count confirmed with venue
-

1–2 Weeks Before

- ☐ Final confirmation sent to all participants
 - ☐ Run of show finalised and shared with team
 - ☐ Equipment / props packed or sourced
 - ☐ Contingency plans made for key risks
 - ☐ Personal practice and preparation time scheduled
-

Day Before & Morning Of

- ☐ Venue walkthrough and setup
-

☐ Team briefed and in position

☐ All materials on-site

☐ You have eaten, rested, and grounded yourself

☐ Contingency plans revisited

Day-Of & Programme *Design.*

Hold the space, not the agenda. Your run of show is a guide — not a script. The best facilitation leaves room for what wants to happen.

THE OPENING SETS EVERYTHING

How you open is how participants settle. Give them time to arrive — physically and emotionally. Rushing the opening rushes the whole day.

CLOSE WITH THE SAME CARE

Integration is the difference between an experience and a shift. Close deliberately — with gratitude, grounding, and a clear transition out.

Run of Show Template

TIME	ELEMENT	FACILITATOR	NOTES
	Arrival / welcome		
	Opening circle / grounding		
	Break		
	Break		
	Closing circle / integration		
	Departure		

Contingency Planning

Every event has something go differently than planned. The hosts who handle it gracefully are not the ones who planned for everything — they are the ones who stayed calm and adapted. Plan for the most likely scenarios and let the rest go.

SCENARIO	PLAN B	WHO HANDLES IT
Key facilitator cancels		
Venue issue on the day		
Tech failure (sound, projector)		

Participant medical situation

Low bookings at close

Weather (outdoor events)

Post-Event & *Growth.*

What happens after the event shapes how much of the shift actually lands — and how effectively this event builds your next one.

Post-Event Timeline

- ☐ Within 24 hours — thank you email to all participants
- ☐ Within 48 hours — feedback form sent (5–8 questions max)
- ☐ Week 1 — team debrief, venue follow-up, supplier payments
- ☐ Week 2 — testimonial collection, photo editing, social content
- ☐ Week 3–4 — debrief document completed, learnings recorded
- ☐ Month 2 — use photos, testimonials, and stories to begin marketing the next one

Post-Event Debrief

WHAT WORKED BETTER THAN EXPECTED?

WHAT WOULD I CHANGE?

PARTICIPANT FEEDBACK THEMES

WHAT I WANT TO DO DIFFERENTLY NEXT TIME

YOUR SPACE

Notes.

Free space for ideas, questions, things you don't want to forget.

WHAT COMES NEXT

Keep *building.*

The guide is done. Now use it. And when you are ready for more support:

Genuine Reach — the companion marketing guide. From brand positioning and content strategy through to full launch plans and email flows. mindfulearth.eco/pages/genuine-reach

1:1 Strategy Session — CA\$111 — apply this guide to your specific retreat with direct support from Montana. Written plan delivered within 48 hours.

Retreat Planning Support Community — included with your purchase. The link is in your thank-you email.

FIND & FOLLOW

Instagram: @mindfulearth.eco · @montanacindy_

Your support group (Retreat + Event Planning Support): https://chat.whatsapp.com/KKIpsydAzStKgawxo5fXX7?mode=gi_t

Community WhatsApp: <https://chat.whatsapp.com/GzOQyhpVlbS50fCpybsFGp>

Free clarity call: <https://cal.com/montana-king-mrfkvt/clarity-call>

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Recommended *Resources*.

Tools Montana uses or recommends. Not sponsored — just what actually works.

CATEGORY	TOOL	WHAT IT'S FOR
Booking	Stripe stripe.com	Payment processing for event bookings
	Cal.com / Calendly cal.com	Scheduling, booking calls, clarity sessions
	Eventbrite eventbrite.com	Ticketing for workshops and day events
Forms	Google Forms forms.google.com	Free registration, health intake, feedback forms
	Jotform jotform.com	Advanced forms with e-signatures and payments
	DocuSign docusign.com	Digital signatures for venue and team contracts
Email	Flodesk flodesk.com	Montana's recommendation — beautiful design, flat fee
	Mailchimp mailchimp.com	Free up to 500 contacts, solid automation
	ConvertKit convertkit.com	Built for creators, strong email sequences
Planning	Notion notion.so	All-in-one workspace for event planning and checklists
	Canva canva.com	Marketing design, event materials, social graphics

More resources shared regularly in the WhatsApp community and at mindfulearth.eco/pages/journal/

10-Step Planning Quick Reference

- ☐ Ground yourself and clarify your vision
- ☐ Choose your format — start smaller than you think
- ☐ Build your budget before booking anything
- ☐ Find and secure your venue
- ☐ Build your team and confirm everything in writing
- ☐ Sort your forms and insurance
- ☐ Open bookings and begin marketing (6 weeks out)
- ☐ Work through pre-event checklists (8 wks through day before)
- ☐ Run the event — hold the space, not the agenda
- ☐ Follow up, rest, reflect, and start the next one

NEED SUPPORT?

Join the WhatsApp community · Book a free clarity call ·
Email connect@mindfulearth.eco

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A wellness ecosystem for practitioners, seekers, and the people building something real. Community, education, experiences, and the support to build sustainably.

CONTINUE THE WORK

Genuine Reach — The Complete Marketing Guide

mindfulearth.eco/pages/genuine-reach/

Your WhatsApp support group — Retreat + Event Planning Support

https://chat.whatsapp.com/KKlpsydAzStKgawxo5fXX7?mode=gi_t

Free 30-min clarity call with Montana

<https://cal.com/montana-king-mrfkvt/clarity-call>

FIND US

Instagram: @mindfulearth.eco · @montanacindy_

WhatsApp Community: mindfulearth.eco/pages/community/

Website: mindfulearth.eco

Recommended *Resources*.

Tools and platforms referenced throughout this guide. All recommendations are based on genuine use — nothing here is sponsored.

CATEGORY	TOOL	NOTES
BOOKING & TICKETING	Eventbrite	eventbrite.com — general events, large reach
	Stripe	stripe.com — direct payment links, low fees
	Acuity / Calendly	scheduling and intake forms
	Ticket Tailor	tickettailor.com — low-fee ticketing for small events
VENUE SOURCING	Venuescanner	venuescanner.com — UK venues
	Spacehuntr	spacehuntr.com — Europe venues
	Peerspace	peerspace.com — US, UK, and global
	Google Maps	search "retreat centre near [location]" — local gems often not listed elsewhere
LEGAL & FORMS	Typeform	typeform.com — beautiful intake forms
	Google Forms	free, simple, integrates with sheets
	HelloSign / DocuSign	e-signatures for waivers and contracts
	Simply Business	simplybusiness.co.uk — UK event insurance
OPERATIONS & PLANNING	Notion	notion.so — project planning and run-of-show
	Trello	trello.com — visual task management
	Canva	canva.com — welcome packs, schedules, signage
	Flodesk	flodesk.com — email marketing for practitioners

The Essential *Checklists.*

Cut this page out or print separately. Pin it up during the planning period.

PRE-LAUNCH (8–12 WKS)

- ☐ Vision and concept locked
- ☐ Format and dates confirmed
- ☐ Budget built (minimum viable)
- ☐ Venue shortlisted
- ☐ Team conversations started
- ☐ Ticket price set
- ☐ Booking page built
- ☐ Insurance sorted
- ☐ Forms built and tested
- ☐ Marketing begun

POST-EVENT (WEEK 1–2)

- ☐ Thank you email sent (24hrs)
- ☐ Feedback form sent (48hrs)
- ☐ Team debrief done
- ☐ Supplier payments settled
- ☐ Testimonials collected
- ☐ Photos edited and shared
- ☐ Debrief document complete
- ☐ Rest scheduled

WEEK OF EVENT

- ☐ Final confirmation sent to all
- ☐ Run of show finalised
- ☐ Team briefed
- ☐ All materials packed
- ☐ Contingency plans reviewed
- ☐ You have rested and eaten
- ☐ Venue walkthrough done
- ☐ Tech tested
- ☐ Emergency contacts confirmed
- ☐ You are grounded and ready

KEY NUMBERS TO KNOW

- ☐ Minimum viable participants: _____
- ☐ Target participants: _____
- ☐ Ticket price: _____
- ☐ Total costs: _____
- ☐ Break-even point: _____
- ☐ My fee: _____
- ☐ Bookings close date: _____
- ☐ Venue contact: _____



A wellness ecosystem for practitioners, seekers, and the people building something real. Rooted in community. Built for belonging.

YOUR COMPANION GUIDE

Genuine Reach — The Complete Wellness Marketing Guide

mindfulearth.eco/pages/genuine-reach/

JOIN THE COMMUNITY

💬 Retreat Planning Support — your private WhatsApp group

https://chat.whatsapp.com/KKlpsydAzStKgawxo5fXX7?mode=gi_t

🌿 Main community: chat.whatsapp.com/GzOQyhpVlbS50fCpybsFGp

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🌐 mindfulearth.eco

📞 Free clarity call: cal.com/montana-king-mrfkvt/clarity-call
